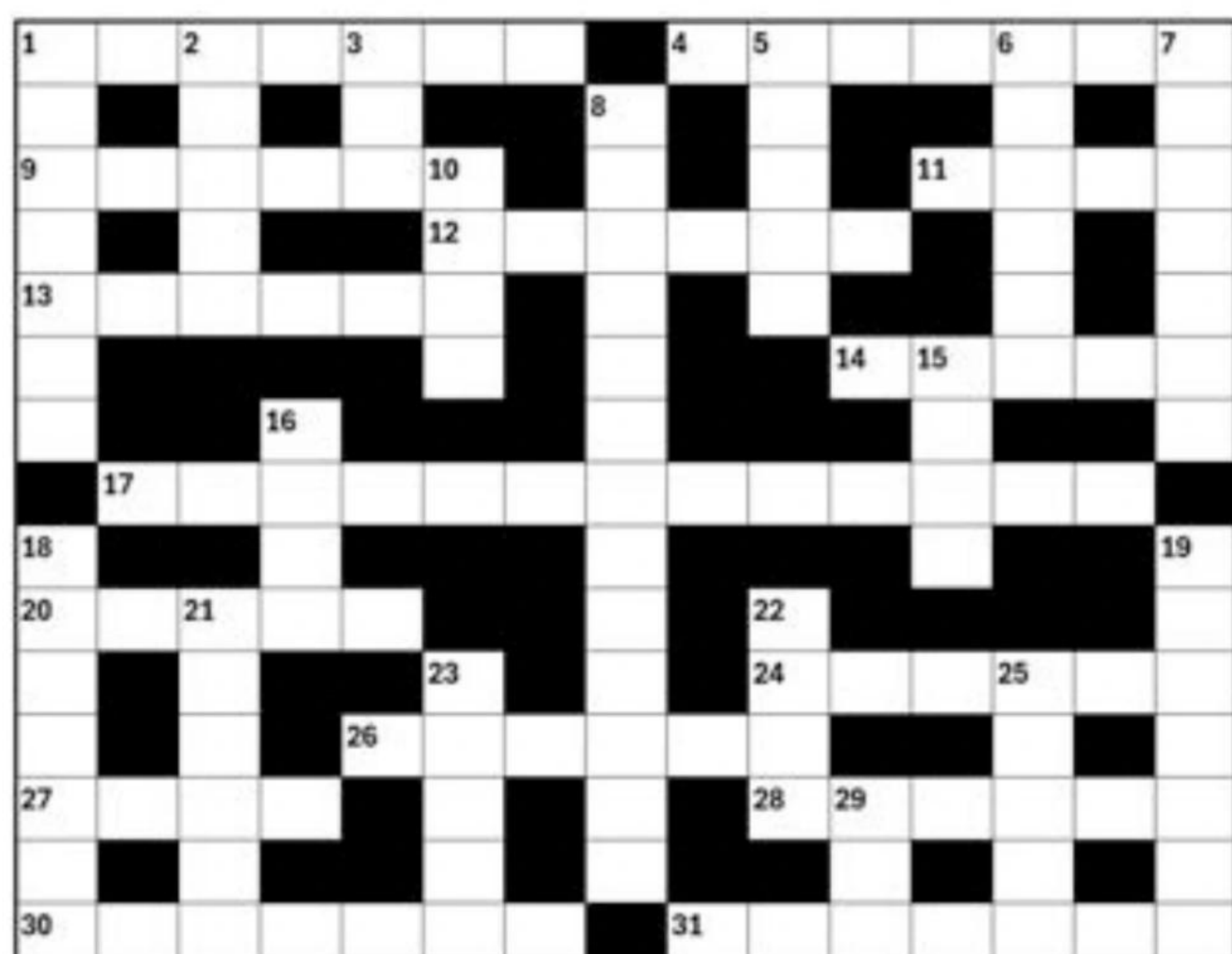


CROSSWORD

N. SOORYA PRAKASH



SOLUTION TO LAST FORTNIGHT'S CROSSWORD

ACROSS

- 1** Identify the first name of this footballer who scored a hat-trick for Newcastle United in the UEFA Champions League encounter versus Qarabag on February 18, 2026. (7)
- 4** Identify the first name of this player who won the player of the match award in the T20 WC match held between USA and Netherlands. (7)
- 9** Identify the surname of this cricketer who won the player of the series award in the T20I series held between Sri Lanka and England recently. (6)
- 11** Identify the first name of this cricketer who won the player of the series award of "The Hundred" competition in its very first year in 2021. (4)
- 12** Identify the surname of the former coach of Real Madrid who was sacked recently. (6)
- 13** Identify the surname of this cricketer who played all three formats for both Ireland and England. (6)
- 14** FTB: Golden ___ is awarded to the outstanding goalkeeper at the end of every football World Cup. (5)
- 17** Who was the batting coach of Rajasthan Royals in IPL 2025? (6,7)
- 20** Identify the surname of this footballer who scored a hat-trick for VFB Stuttgart in Bundesliga against Borussia Dortmund on November 22, 2025. (5)
- 24** Identify the surname of the New Zealand captain who scored a century in each innings in the third Test match versus West Indies in December 2025. (6)

- 26** Identify the surname of this athlete who won a historic ninth gold at the Winter Olympics during the 25th edition Olympics held in Italy. (6)
- 27** Identify the first name of this former French footballer and now an actor, who was regarded as one of the greatest-ever players of Manchester United. (4)
- 28** What is the lengthy break in a day and night Test match called? (6)
- 30** Identify the first name of the Chairperson of the Global Chess League. (7)
- 31** Identify the first name of the CEO of Formula One racing. (7)

DOWN

- 1** Identify the surname of this player who recently completed a career Grand Slam in tennis. (7)
- 2** In which city was the men's ATP Tour final of 2025 played? (5)
- 3** What is the acronym for the off-season training sessions held for NFL? (1,1,1)
- 5** Identify the first name of the under-19 World Cup 2026-winning Indian captain. (5)
- 6** Identify the first name of this Spanish player who won the joint silver boot in the 1986 FIFA World Cup. (6)
- 7** Identify the first name of this Kazakh player who ended as runner-up in the men's singles at the Bengaluru Open Tennis 2026. (7)
- 8** Who finished fourth in the Formula One Drivers' Championship in 2025? (6,7)
- 10** Who wore the captain's armband for Portugal after Cristiano Ronaldo was injured in the EURO 2016 final which

Portugal eventually won in extra-time? (4)

- 15** Identify the city which plays a major, historic and culinary capital frequently used to bridge the gap between intermediate stages and Alps of Tour de France. (4)
- 16** Identify the surname of this 2022 Arjuna Awardee for hockey, who was part of the Indian team that finished fourth at the Tokyo Olympics in 2021, and won medals at the 2014, 2018 and 2023 Asian Games. (4)
- 18** Identify the first name of this player who was the highest wicket-taker at last year's Asia Cup. (7)
- 19** Identify the first name of this cricketer who took five wickets, including a hat-trick, in the second match of 2026 T20 WC held in Kolkata on February 7, 2026. (7)
- 21** Identify the surname of this cricketer who was adjudged as player of the WPL 2026. (6)
- 22** What is it called in the game of cricket when a batter adopts to a slow, methodical, or unexciting style of batting or play, often described as "stonewalling"? (4)
- 23** Identify the surname of this cricketer who won the player of the match award in the 2026 T20 WC game between Australia and Ireland. (5)
- 25** FTB: ___ Racing Corporation will supply power units to Aston Aramco Formula One team in 2026. (5)
- 29** FTB: ___ Hockey is the national winter sport of Canada. (3)